

PD-1/PD-L1s:

Bavencio (Avelumab), Imfinzi (Durvalumab), Jemperli (Dostarlimab), Keytruda (Pembrolizumab), Keytruda Qlex (Pembrolizumab and berahyaluronidase alfa-pmph), Libtayo (Cemiplimab), Loqtorzi (Toripalimab), Opdivo (Nivolumab), Opdivo Qvantig (nivolumab and hyaluronidase-nvhy), Opdualag (Nivolumab and Relatimab-rmbw), Penpulimab-kcqx, Tecentriq (Atezolizumab), Tecentriq Hybreza (atezolizumab and hyaluronidase-tqjs), Tevimbra (Tislelizumab), Unloxcyt (cosibelimab-ipdl), Zynyz (Retifanlimab-dlwr)

Original Effective Date: 11/1/2023

Revision Date(s): 11/1/23; 2/1/24; 2/23/24; 4/16/24; 4/29/24; 7/1/24; 7/30/2024; 9/4/2024; 10/2/2024; 1/21/2025; 5/27/2025; 07/01/2025; 11/17/2025; 4/1/2026

Review Date: 4/1/2026

Policy type: Medical Necessity

Line of Business: All G.E.H.A Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan, or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety, and tolerability.

Maximum total length of initial therapy with PD-1/PD-L1 Inhibitor for metastatic non-small cell lung cancer is 2 years^{1,2}.

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
 - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
 - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**
- Other uses of drugs and biologics may be considered medically necessary if supported as safe and effective according to peer-reviewed articles from one of the following journals:
 - American Journal of Medicine; Annals of Internal Medicine; Annals of Oncology; Annals of Surgical Oncology; Biology of Blood and Marrow Transplantation; Blood; Bone Marrow

¹[Sun L, Bleiberg B, Hwang W, et al. Association Between Duration of Immunotherapy and Overall Survival in Advanced Non-Small Cell Lung Cancer. JAMA Oncol. 2023;9\(8\):1075–1082.](#)

Transplantation; British Journal of Cancer; British Journal of Hematology; British Medical Journal; Cancer; Clinical Cancer Research; Drugs; European Journal of Cancer (formerly the European Journal of Cancer and Clinical Oncology); Gynecologic Oncology; International Journal of Radiation, Oncology, Biology, and Physics; The Journal of the American Medical Association, Journal of Clinical Oncology; Journal of the National Cancer Institute; Journal of the National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN); Journal of Urology; Lancet; Lancet Oncology; Leukemia; The New England Journal of Medicine; Radiation Oncology;

- **Meeting abstracts and case reports are excluded from consideration;**
- Non-standard protocols may be approved based on unique clinical circumstances;
- Dose and frequency should be consistent with United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling, National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN), or indication specific peer-reviewed literature;
- In the instance that a request is made for drug(s) that was (were) previously tried (including in the same pharmacologic class or with the same mechanism of action) and such drug(s) was (were) discontinued due to a lack of efficacy the request may be subject to an off-label review for medical necessity unless supported by the NCCN or high quality literature (prospective phase 2 or 3 studies published as full manuscripts in a CMS-supported journal).

Billing

Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Bavencio	J9023	Injection, avelumab, 10 mg
Imfinzi	J9173	Injection, durvalumab, 10 mg
Jemperli	J9272	Injection, dostarlimab-gxly, 10 mg
Keytruda	J9271	Injection, pembrolizumab, 1 mg
Keytruda Qlex	J9277	Injection, pembrolizumab, 1 mg, and berahyaluronidase alfapmph.
Libtayo	J9119	Injection, cemiplimab-rwlc, 1 mg
Loqtorzi	J3263	Injection, toripalimab-tpzi, 1 mg
Opdivo	J9299	Injection, nivolumab, 1 mg
Opdivo Qvantig	J9289	Injection, nivolumab, 2 mg and hyaluronidase-nvhy
Opdualag	J9298	Injection, nivolumab and relatlimab-rmbw, 3 mg/1 mg
penpulimab-kcqx	J9999	Not otherwise classified, antineoplastic drugs
Tecentriq	J9022	Injection, atezolizumab, 10 mg
Tecentriq Hybreza	J9024	Injection, atezolizumab, 5 mg and hyaluronidase-tqjs
Tevimbra	J9329	Injection, tislelizumab-jsgr, 1 mg
Unloxcyt	J9275	Injection, cosibelimab-ipdl, 2 mg
Zynyz	J9345	Injection, retifanlimab-dlwr, 1 mg

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Disclaimer

Drug Coverage Policies are developed as needed, reviewed and updated at least annually, and are subject to change. Other policies and coverage determination guidelines may apply. Federal and state regulatory requirements and member specific benefit plan documents, if applicable, must be reviewed prior to utilizing this Drug Coverage Policy. This Drug Coverage Policy is for informational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice nor dictate how providers should practice medicine. This policy should not be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or altered from its original form without written permission from OncoHealth, Inc.

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Date	Updates
11/1/2023	Combined individual PD-1/PD-L1 policies into a single document Added total therapy limit metastatic NSCLC
2/1/2024	Additional cite
2/23/2024	Updated Universal Criteria
4/16/2024	Updated Universal Criteria
4/29/24	Added Tevimbra
6/1/2024	Policy adopted by GEHA; document updated for universal accessibility
7/1/24	Updated Loqtorzi HCPCS
7/30/2024	Annual Review – Update to Universal Criteria, auth span, disclaimer
9/4/2024	Updated Tevimbra HCPCS
10/2/2024	Addition of Tecentriq Hybreza
1/21/2025	Addition of Opdivo Qvantig, Unloxcyt
5/27/2025	Addition of Penpulimab-kcqx, approved at 5/27/2025 P&T, addition of Tecentriq Hybreza HCPCS
7/1/2025	Updated HCPCS for Unloxcyt (J9275), Opdivo Qvantig (J9289)
11/17/2025	Addition of Keytruda Qlex (J9999)
4/1/2026	Update HCPCS for Keytruda Olex (from J9999 to J9277)